

# ARISE

Adolescent Reproductive Health Information Support & Empowerment

## SHISHA & TOBACCO

# Shisha / Hookah — Myths & Real Risks

*Student Study Guide & Quiz Answer Key*

|                   |                                                       |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Module:</b>    | Shisha & Tobacco                                      |
| <b>Lesson:</b>    | Shisha / Hookah — Myths & Real Risks                  |
| <b>Quiz:</b>      | 25 marks (10 MCQ + 5 Fill-in-blanks + 3 Short Answer) |
| <b>Pass Mark:</b> | 15/25 (60%) — Certificate awarded at 60%+             |
| <b>Languages:</b> | English   Kiswahili   Sheng                           |

## Learning Outcomes

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By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

1. Explain what shisha is and how it is produced and consumed
2. Debunk the top myths about shisha being safer than cigarettes using scientific evidence
3. Identify the specific chemicals in shisha smoke and their health effects
4. Explain how shisha creates nicotine addiction and the social normalisation risk
5. Apply refusal skills to shisha peer pressure situations in Kenya



## Quiz — Answer Key

Total: 25 marks | Pass: 15/25 (60%) | Certificate at 60%+

### Part A: Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. 1. How much MORE tar does one shisha session produce compared to smoking one cigarette?

- ☐ A. 5 times more
- ☐ B. 10 times more
- ☐ C. 36 times more
- ☐ D. Same amount as a cigarette

2. 2. Why does the water in a shisha pipe NOT make it safer?

- ☐ A. The water evaporates before filtering anything
- ☐ B. Water only cools the smoke — toxins like CO, nicotine and tar still pass through unchanged
- ☐ C. Water turns chemicals into harmless vapour
- ☐ D. The flavouring in the tobacco cancels out toxins

3. 3. Sharing a shisha pipe can transmit which of the following infections?

- ☐ A. Only herpes simplex virus
- ☐ B. Only tuberculosis
- ☐ C. Only COVID-19
- ☐ D. Tuberculosis, herpes, hepatitis and respiratory infections

4. 4. One shisha session delivers approximately how much nicotine?

- ☐ A. Equivalent to half a cigarette
- ☐ B. Equivalent to 2 cigarettes
- ☐ C. Equivalent to 10 cigarettes
- ☐ D. No measurable nicotine

5. 5. Under Kenya's Tobacco Control Act 2007, shisha:

- ☐ A. Is completely unregulated and legal for all ages
- ☐ B. Is covered under tobacco law — sale to under-18s is illegal and smoking in public is banned
- ☐ C. Is legal for people over 16
- ☐ D. Is only banned in schools and hospitals

6. 6. Which toxic metal found in shisha smoke comes primarily from the hookah equipment itself?

- ☐ A. Lead and arsenic from the metal pipes and fittings
- ☐ B. Nicotine from the tobacco
- ☐ C. Tar from the flavouring chemicals
- ☐ D. Carbon monoxide from the fruit flavours

7. 7. The MOST accurate description of herbal (tobacco-free) shisha is:

- ☐ A. Completely safe because it contains no tobacco
- ☐ B. Slightly less harmful but still contains some nicotine
- ☐ C. Still harmful because charcoal combustion produces CO, benzene and other toxins regardless of tobacco
- ☐ D. Safe for people with asthma as it does not contain tar

**8. 8. When Achieng's friend says "Shisha is just flavoured steam — not a real drug," the BEST factual response is:**

- ☐ A. Agree and try it once to be polite
- ☐ B. Ignore them and walk away without explanation
- ☐ C. Say it is haram and refuse on religious grounds only
- ☐ D. Say: "Actually, shisha smoke contains nicotine, tar, and carbon monoxide — one session equals 10 cigarettes of nicotine and 36 cigarettes of tar."

**9. 9. Benzene found in shisha smoke is particularly dangerous because it:**

- ☐ A. Is a known cause of leukaemia (blood cancer)
- ☐ B. Makes the smoke smell unpleasant
- ☐ C. Causes immediate respiratory failure
- ☐ D. Reacts with nicotine to create a more addictive compound

**10. 10. A hookah lounge in Nairobi advertises "nicotine-free, organic fruit shisha." This product:**

- ☐ A. Is completely safe as it contains no nicotine or tobacco
- ☐ B. Still exposes users to charcoal toxins including CO, benzene and heavy metals from equipment
- ☐ C. Is legal to sell to under-18s because it has no tobacco
- ☐ D. Has been approved by Kenya Bureau of Standards as safe

### **Part C: Short Answer (13 marks)**

**1. One shisha session produces approximately \_\_\_\_\_ times more tar than a single cigarette. (3 marks)**

**2. A friend tells you "Shisha is safer than cigarettes because the water filters the smoke." Using specific facts, explain why this is false. (4 marks)**

**3. Describe THREE specific health risks of sharing a shisha pipe, other than nicotine addiction. (3 marks)**

**4. Explain the concept of social normalisation and why it makes shisha particularly dangerous for Kenyan youth. (3 marks)**